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MOHAMMED INAUGURATES TUNNELLING WORKS FOR BLUE LINE

■ His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, inaugurated tunnelling works for the Dubai Metro Blue Line yesterday. The 30-kilometre route, valued at Dh20.5 billion, will feature 14 stations and serve nine key districts with a combined population of around one million residents, in line with the Dubai 2040 Urban Master Plan.

SEE ALSO P2

Adnoc unveils Dh200b project pipeline for next phase of growth

Projects to usher in new phase of world-scale execution to meet global demand

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Adnoc yesterday confirmed it is accelerating growth, with Dh200 billion (\$55 billion) allocated to new projects for 2026-2028.

The planned project awards reinforce delivery of Adnoc's five-year capital expenditure (CAPEX) plan approved by its Board of Directors last year and will usher in a new phase of world-scale project execution across its value chain to meet growing global energy demand.

The announcement was made at the 'Make it With Adnoc' Forum, which connected top engineering, procurement and construction (EPC) contractors with 70 local manufacturers included in Adnoc's



Gulf News Archives

■ Dr Sultan Ahmed Al Jaber

'Local+' list after meeting its technical and qualification standards to support the company's project requirements.

The 'Local+' initiative under Adnoc's In-Country Value (ICV) programme is aimed at ensuring that Made in the Emirates products are first-choice across Adnoc's project delivery, supporting the growth of local manufacturers.

The planned project awards span Adnoc's upstream and downstream operations and usher in a new phase of project

delivery that will supercharge UAE's manufacturing capacity, strengthen industrial resilience, deepen the impact of the company's In-Country Value programme and advance the 'Make it in the Emirates' initiative.

New chapter

Dr Sultan Ahmed Al Jaber, UAE Minister of Industry and Advanced Technology and Adnoc Managing Director and Group CEO, said: "This marks a new chapter of growth and resilience to meet rising global energy demand while strengthening and expanding the UAE's industrial and manufacturing base. As we deliver on this phase of growth, we are bringing together leading EPC contractors with 70 top UAE manufacturers to enhance accountability, maximise in-country value and ensure Made in the Emirates products are first-choice across our projects, and are at the core of how we procure, build and execute."

SEE ALSO P8,10

Sudden swerving leading cause of accidents in UAE

Light vehicles were involved in 3,834 accidents in 2025

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Light vehicles were responsible for the largest share of traffic accidents across the UAE last year, according to new figures released by the UAE Ministry of Interior.

Light vehicles were involved in 3,834 accidents, far exceeding other categories. Motorcycles ranked second, with 1,224 incidents, followed by heavy trucks, which were linked to 325 accidents.

Other vehicle types accounted for smaller but notable shares. Bicycles were involved in 158 accidents, while heavy buses (with a capacity of 27 passengers or more) recorded

131. Electric scooters accounted for 120 incidents, followed by light buses with 115, and e-bikes with 62.

6,014 traffic accidents

Overall, the UAE recorded 6,014 traffic accidents during the year. Of these, 4,085 were collisions between vehicles, 1,102 involved pedestrians being struck, and 800 were vehicle rollovers. A further 27 incidents were classified under other categories.

The figures also highlight the leading causes behind these accidents. Sudden swerving topped the list, accounting for 1,074 incidents, followed by driver distraction in all its forms, with 948 cases. Failing to leave a safe distance between vehicles contributed to 849 accidents, while negligence and lack of attention were cited in 661 cases.

UAE URGES UNCONDITIONAL REOPENING OF HORMUZ

'Iran's actions risk global trade, maritime security'

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

The UAE has raised concerns over Iran's actions across diplomatic, environmental and security fronts, calling at the United Nations for the immediate and unconditional reopening of the Strait of Hormuz and warning that continued disruption threatens global trade and maritime security.

Addressing a UN Security Council debate on maritime security, Minister of State Sheikh Khalifa Shaheen Al Marar said recent developments posed a serious threat to international shipping lanes. "The Council has taken important steps in recent years to address threats to maritime security," he said, pointing to attacks on Gulf states and deliberate obstruction of navigation through the strait. He cited Security Council Resolution 2817, which condemns attempts to disrupt maritime traffic, and warned that allowing such actions to continue "risks setting a dangerous precedent" for global waterways.

Pattern of violations

Al Marar outlined what he described as a pattern of violations, including illegal fees on passing vessels, attacks and threats against shipping, the laying of mines and discriminatory practices against foreign ships. "In the face of this economic coercion and these clear violations of international law, my country

TRUMP REVIEWS IRAN PROPOSAL

Iran's Revolutionary Guards said yesterday that the US faces a choice between an "impossible" military operation or accepting what it called a "bad deal", after US President Donald Trump dismissed Tehran's latest peace proposal.

Iranian media reported that Tehran has submitted a 14-point proposal via mediator Pakistan, including steps to reopen the Strait of Hormuz and end the conflict.

Trump said he would review the proposal but signalled scepticism, saying Iran had "not yet paid a big enough price". He also warned that military action remained an option.

— S. N. R.

holds Iran responsible," he said, adding that Tehran must provide compensation for damages, including environmental impact. He stressed that disruption to the strait could have far-reaching consequences for energy security, supply chains, and food and fertiliser availability, particularly in developing nations.

Gargash stresses global coordination

Separately, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said ongoing discussions on the security of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz underscore the importance of collective international action and adherence to international law.

In a post on X, he said these principles remain the main guarantee for freedom of navigation and regional stability, adding that the current situation highlights the need for a coordinated international approach. He also criticised unilateral arrangements, saying they cannot be relied upon following what

he described as Iran's aggression against its neighbours.

In another post on X yesterday, Gargash said the UAE's resilience and strategic autonomy will enable it to navigate ongoing regional challenges while continuing to promote stability and progress. He reflected on the country's trajectory, describing its transformation from "difficult beginnings" into "a consequential and assertive state" shaped by leadership, vision and discipline.

Iran's NPT role rejected

The UAE earlier rejected Iran's nomination for a leadership role at the review conference of the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty, saying it would undermine the credibility of the global non-proliferation regime.

Authorities, meanwhile, issued a travel advisory banning UAE nationals from visiting Iran, Iraq and Lebanon and urged those currently in these countries to return immediately.

SEE ALSO P6,13



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